ENGLISH B2 · ADVANCED GRAMMAR

Advanced comparison

Modify comparatives, express proportional change and compare equivalent degrees with precise scaling expressions. The lesson connects form, meaning, register and real editorial decisions rather than treating the pattern as an isolated rule.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Use advanced comparison to describe the size, pace and relationship of differences rather than making a simple binary comparison while preserving the intended meaning and register.

Modify comparatives, express proportional change and compare equivalent degrees with precise scaling expressions.

MODEL

The revised process is considerably faster and almost as accurate as the original.

much/far/slightly + comparative | the more..., the more... | as...as

6 GUIDED STAGES · 30 LEARNING DECISIONS

This complete guide combines explanation, visual reasoning, practice and feedback. Separate exercise and answer-key editions are also available from the lesson page.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

OUTCOME 1

01

Recognise the main advanced comparison patterns in authentic contexts.

OUTCOME 2

02

Choose a form that accurately expresses describe the size, pace and relationship of differences rather than making a simple binary comparison.

OUTCOME 3

03

Avoid errors that change time, agency, emphasis or speaker commitment.

OUTCOME 4

04

Use the structure appropriately in data commentary, reviews, reports and analytical discussion.

Build meaning before form

Modify comparatives, express proportional change and compare equivalent degrees with precise scaling expressions.

What advanced comparison communicates

Modify comparatives, express proportional change and compare equivalent degrees with precise scaling expressions.

The central purpose is to describe the size, pace and relationship of differences rather than making a simple binary comparison. A successful choice therefore preserves the proposition while making the intended relationship, viewpoint or degree of commitment visible to the reader.

The revised process is considerably faster.	the degree of difference between two items
The longer the delay continues, the more expensive recovery becomes.	two changes that develop in relation to each other
The new model is almost as accurate as the original.	a comparison close to but not fully equal

How the pattern is built

Use this working formula: much/far/slightly + comparative | the more..., the more... | as...as. The formula is a decision path: it identifies the trigger, the clause architecture and the element that carries tense or modality.

The model “The revised process is considerably faster and almost as accurate as the original.” shows the complete pattern in context. Rebuild the sentence from meaning to form instead of translating each word independently.

Choice	Structure	Example
Modified difference	much/far/slightly + comparative	The revised process is considerably faster.
Proportional relation	the + comparative, the + comparative	The longer the delay continues, the more expensive recovery becomes.
Near equivalence	almost/nearly/not quite as + adjective + as	The new model is almost as accurate as the original.

Choose by meaning, not by surface similarity

Neighbouring structures may contain similar words but perform different jobs. Compare the three reference patterns and name the intended effect before completing the sentence.

A reliable answer explains both why the chosen form works and why a plausible alternative would change the meaning, time relation, information focus or level of certainty.

Meaning	Best route
the degree of difference between two items	Modified difference
two changes that develop in relation to each other	Proportional relation
a comparison close to but not fully equal	Near equivalence

Register, discourse and editorial control

This grammar is especially useful in data commentary, reviews, reports and analytical discussion. Its value comes from helping the reader process a relationship efficiently, not from making the sentence sound artificially complex.

After editing, check recoverability, natural word order and consistency with the surrounding paragraph. If the marked structure creates ambiguity, return to a fuller or more neutral clause.

Reason through the pattern

The visual map moves from communicative purpose to structural trigger, then to the final clause. It keeps meaning and form visible at the same time so the learner can justify every choice.

01	02	03	04
much/far/slightly	comparative	the more..., the more...	as...as

DECIDE IN THIS ORDER

STEP 1

Decision 1

Identify the communicative purpose before selecting a form: describe the size, pace and relationship of differences rather than making a simple binary comparison.

STEP 2

Decision 2

Locate the structural trigger and match it to one of the reference patterns.

STEP 3

Decision 3

Check time reference, clause relationships, agency and speaker commitment.

STEP 4

Decision 4

Read the complete sentence in context and confirm that its register suits data commentary, reviews, reports and analytical discussion.

STEP 5

Decision 5

Compare the result with a neutral alternative and keep the marked form only when it adds useful meaning.

Compare forms and meanings

Use the table to justify each structural choice.

Pattern	Form	Model
Modified difference	much/far/slightly + comparative	The revised process is considerably faster.
Proportional relation	the + comparative, the + comparative	The longer the delay continues, the more expensive recovery becomes.
Near equivalence	almost/nearly/not quite as + adjective + as	The new model is almost as accurate as the original.

EXAMPLES AT A GLANCE

The revised process is considerably faster.	the degree of difference between two items
The longer the delay continues, the more expensive recovery becomes.	two changes that develop in relation to each other
The new model is almost as accurate as the original.	a comparison close to but not fully equal

COMMON ERRORS

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not use very directly before a comparative adjective.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not omit the before either comparative in the proportional pattern.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not use than after an as...as structure.

01 · PRACTICE STAGE

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: the degree of difference between two items?

OPTIONS The revised process is considerably faster. · The longer the delay continues, the more expensive recovery becomes. · The new model is almost as accurate as the original.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: two changes that develop in relation to each other?

OPTIONS The longer the delay continues, the more expensive recovery becomes. · The new model is almost as accurate as the original. · The revised process is considerably faster.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a comparison close to but not fully equal?

OPTIONS The new model is almost as accurate as the original. · The revised process is considerably faster. · The longer the delay continues, the more expensive recovery becomes.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “The revised process is considerably faster.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS the degree of difference between two items · two changes that develop in relation to each other · a comparison close to but not fully equal

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “The longer the delay continues, the more expensive recovery becomes.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS two changes that develop in relation to each other · a comparison close to but not fully equal · the degree of difference between two items

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “The new model is almost as accurate as the original.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a comparison close to but not fully equal · the degree of difference between two items · two changes that develop in relation to each other

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

"The revised process is considerably faster." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Modified difference / Proportional relation / Near equivalence · Gap 2: the degree of difference between two items / two changes that develop in relation to each other / a comparison close to but not fully equal

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

"The longer the delay continues, the more expensive recovery becomes." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Proportional relation / Near equivalence / Modified difference · Gap 2: two changes that develop in relation to each other / a comparison close to but not fully equal / the degree of difference between two items

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

"The new model is almost as accurate as the original." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Near equivalence / Modified difference / Proportional relation · Gap 2: a comparison close to but not fully equal / the degree of difference between two items / two changes that develop in relation to each other

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses the degree of difference between two items: _____. Choose the model that expresses two changes that develop in relation to each other: _____. Choose the model that expresses a comparison close to but not fully equal: _____. Choose the model built with much/far/slightly + comparative: _____. Choose the model built with the + comparative, the + comparative: _____. Choose the model built with almost/nearly/not quite as + adjective + as: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

The longer the delay continues, the more expensive recovery becomes. · The new model is almost as accurate as the original. · The revised process is considerably faster.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

The revised process is _____. _____ the delay continues, the more expensive recovery becomes. The new model is _____ the original. State the full structural pattern for Modified difference: _____. State the full structural pattern for Proportional relation: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “The process is faster by a considerable margin.” using the Modified difference pattern to express the degree of difference between two items.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “Cost rises as the delay becomes longer.” using the Proportional relation pattern to express two changes that develop in relation to each other.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “The accuracy is slightly lower than the original.” using the Near equivalence pattern to express a comparison close to but not fully equal.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “The process is faster by a considerable margin.” using the Modified difference pattern to express the degree of difference between two items.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Modified difference to express the degree of difference between two items, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Proportional relation to express two changes that develop in relation to each other, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Near equivalence to express a comparison close to but not fully equal, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

07 · RETRIEVAL

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____
_____

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

The revised process is considerably faster.

Modified difference is the best match because the degree of difference between two items.

A2

The longer the delay continues, the more expensive recovery becomes.

Proportional relation is the best match because two changes that develop in relation to each other.

A3

The new model is almost as accurate as the original.

Near equivalence is the best match because a comparison close to but not fully equal.

A4

the degree of difference between two items

The Modified difference pattern communicates the degree of difference between two items.

A5

two changes that develop in relation to each other

The Proportional relation pattern communicates two changes that develop in relation to each other.

A6

a comparison close to but not fully equal

The Near equivalence pattern communicates a comparison close to but not fully equal.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Modified difference / the degree of difference between two items

The structure belongs to the Modified difference pattern. Its communicative purpose is the degree of difference between two items.

B2

Proportional relation / two changes that develop in relation to each other

The structure belongs to the Proportional relation pattern. Its communicative purpose is two changes that develop in relation to each other.

B3

Near equivalence / a comparison close to but not fully equal

The structure belongs to the Near equivalence pattern. Its communicative purpose is a comparison close to but not fully equal.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

The revised process is considerably faster.

Modified difference: much/far/slightly + comparative.

C2

The longer the delay continues, the more expensive recovery becomes.

Proportional relation: the + comparative, the + comparative.

C3

The new model is almost as accurate as the original.

Near equivalence: almost/nearly/not quite as + adjective + as.

C4

The revised process is considerably faster.

Modified difference: much/far/slightly + comparative.

C5

The longer the delay continues, the more expensive recovery becomes.

Proportional relation: the + comparative, the + comparative.

C6

The new model is almost as accurate as the original.

Near equivalence: almost/nearly/not quite as + adjective + as.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

considerably faster

Modified difference requires “considerably faster” in this model. much/far/slightly + comparative.

D2

The longer

Proportional relation requires “The longer” in this model. the + comparative, the + comparative.

D3

almost as accurate as

Near equivalence requires “almost as accurate as” in this model. almost/nearly/not quite as + adjective + as.

D4

much/far/slightly + comparative

Modified difference is built as much/far/slightly + comparative.

D5

the + comparative, the + comparative

Proportional relation is built as the + comparative, the + comparative.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

The revised process is considerably faster.

much/far/slightly + comparative. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended modified difference effect.

E2

The longer the delay continues, the more expensive recovery becomes.

the + comparative, the + comparative. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended proportional relation effect.

E3

The new model is almost as accurate as the original.

almost/nearly/not quite as + adjective + as. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended near equivalence effect.

E4

The revised process is considerably faster.

much/far/slightly + comparative. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended modified difference effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

The revised process is considerably faster. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses much/far/slightly + comparative accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

The longer the delay continues, the more expensive recovery becomes. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses the + comparative, the + comparative accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

The new model is almost as accurate as the original. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses almost/nearly/not quite as + adjective + as accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____